MAT 2000: Introduction to Statistics

Investigations for Grace College from Zybooks

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Grace College

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Preface

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Significance

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A worksheet for Grace College from Zybooks

Tire study

A legendary story on college campuses concerns two students who missed an exam because of excessive partying, but they blamed the absence on a flat tire. The professor allowed the students to take a make-up exam in separate rooms. On the exam, the students were asked which tire was flat.

Key Idea 1.1.1 Step 1: Ask a research question. Do students pick which tire went flat in equal proportions? A common conjecture is that students tend to answer "front right" more often than would be expected by chance.

Key Idea 1.1.2 Step 2: Design a study and collect data. To test the conjecture, a professor asked 28 students to imagine being in the same situation as the students in the story and pick one of the four tires. The data is summarized in the table below.

Table 1.1.3

Front left	Front right	Rear left	Rear right
6	14	4	4

Exercise 1.1.4 SteDesign a study and collect data. What are the observational units?

Exercise 1.1.5 SteDesign a study and collect data. What is the variable that is measured and recorded on each observation?

Exercise 1.1.6 SteDesign a study and collect data. In words, what is the parameter of interest?

Exercise 1.1.7 SteDesign a study and collect data. In words, what are the null and alternative hypothesis?

Exercise 1.1.8 SteExplore the data. What proportion of the students picked the right front tire? Is this more than you would expect if students randomly picked one of the four tires?

Exercise 1.1.9 SteExplore the data. Is observing 14 out of 28 picking the front right tire possible if the students are randomly picking between the four tires?

Key Idea 1.1.10 3S strategy (Statistic, Simulate, Strength of Evidence). The 3S Strategy will help you investigate how much evidence the sample data provides in support of the research conjecture.

Exercise 1.1.11 SteDraw inferences. Statistic: What is the statistic of interest and what is the symbol that is associated with that statistic called?

Exercise 1.1.12 SteDraw inferences. Simulate: What values for probability of success ( ), sample size (n), and number of repetitions should be entered into the tool to simulate the study?

Exercise 1.1.13 One proportion simulator. Simulate: What is the center of your null distribution? Does the center you observed make sense? Explain.

Exercise 1.1.14 SteDraw inferences. Strength of evidence: Using your simulation, what is the p-value? What does the p-value represent?

Exercise 1.1.15 SteDraw inferences. Strength of evidence: Using your simulation, what is the standardized statistic? What does this standardized statistic represent?

Exercise 1.1.16 SteDraw inferences. Strength of evidence: Using a theory-based z-test (normal approximation), what is the p-value? Are the validity conditions met?

Exercise 1.1.17 SteDraw inferences. Strength of evidence: Do all three methods yield strong evidence against the null hypothesis that students pick the front right tire one-fourth of the time in the long run?

Exercise 1.1.18 SteFormulate conclusions. What conclusions can you draw from the study?

Exercise 1.1.19 SteFormulate conclusions. What are the wider implications of the study? Do you think the conclusions hold true for people in general?

Exercise 1.1.20 SteLook back and ahead. If you were to repeat this study, what improvements would you make? What further research would you propose related to this topic in the future?

Another tire study

Key Idea 1.1.21 . Another professor conducted a similar study with a smaller class and found that 7 out of 14 students picked the front right tire.

Exercise 1.1.22 SteLook back and ahead. Do you expect that this study will yield stronger, weaker, or the same evidence against the null hypothesis? Explain.

Exercise 1.1.23 SteLook back and ahead. Conduct a simulation analysis and produce a p-value. How does this p-value compare to the p-value you calculated for the sample of 28 students?

A different analysis of the tire study

Key Idea 1.1.24 .

Exercise 1.1.25 SteLook back and ahead. In words, what are the null and alternative hypotheses for this new question?

Exercise 1.1.26 SteLook back and ahead. Conduct a theory-based analysis and produce a p-value. How does this p-value compare to the theory-based p-value you calculated for the sample of 28 students using the original setup?

Exercise 1.1.27 SteLook back and ahead. Do you have strong evidence against the null hypothesis that students choose the right front tire one-fourth of the time in the long run?

Colophon

This book was authored in PreTeXt.